Your Steps — Transition to 18 Plan

Your step-by-step sheet for the move to adult benefits at 18. Start at 16 or 17 if you can — check the box each time you finish a step.

1	**At 16 — start the folder** One folder with: birth certificate, Social Security card, state ID if you have one, a list of doctors with addresses and phone numbers, school records, and a list of medicines. Add papers as they come.	☐
2	**At 16 — write down a normal day** Under adult rules, Social Security looks at what your young adult can and cannot do in a day. Start writing it now: getting up, bathing, eating, school or work, help they need, hard days. True, simple words.	☐
3	**At 17 — decide who can decide at 18** At 18, your child is an adult in the eyes of the law. Decide before the birthday: guardianship, or supported decision-making, plus power of attorney and a HIPAA release so doctors can still talk with you. Start early — papers take time.	☐
4	**At 17 — check the money** SSI has a $2,000 resource limit for one person. Look at bank accounts and savings in your young adult's name. An ABLE account lets them save without hurting SSI — ask us how to open one.	☐
5	**At 17 — get on the waiver lists now** Texas waiver lists (like HCS and TxHmL) are very long. Call your local LIDDA and get on the list now — do not wait until 18. Also write the living plan and ride plan: where they will live, and how they get to work and appointments.	☐
6	**Before 18 — set up ID.me** Social Security uses ID.me to prove who you are online. Set it up before the birthday, and keep the password in the folder.	☐
7	**At 18 — apply under adult rules** At 18, Social Security checks the case again under adult rules, or you file the adult application. Start online at ssa.gov, use your intake answers, and SAVE your Reference # — write it below. It is how you get back in.	☐
8	**After 18 — stay on top of it** Open every letter the same day. Social Security may set an exam — they pay for it. If you get a NO, email southernoakfw@gmail.com right away — do not let the appeal deadline pass. We connect you with special needs attorneys at no upfront fee.	☐

Need help filing? SSA Filing Help is **$50 total**: Jessica guides you on Zoom while YOU file — **up to 4 hours of guidance included**, until your filing is done. Need more time after that? **$10 for every extra 30 minutes**. Email **southernoakfw@gmail.com** to start.

18th birthday: _____ My Reference #: _____

Take it one step at a time — no rush, no pressure. We are proud of you for starting. Se habla español. DISCLAIMER: No refunds for services; NO guarantee of approvals; we are not legal attorneys.